

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-III.3: Collects: The Compressed Petition

Map a Collect's address, ground, petition, means or desired effect, and conclusion without forcing an uncertain clause label

Stage	Stage III — Independent Missal Reading
Prerequisite	EL-III.2 and complete control of core subordinate-clause syntax
Next	EL-III.4, Secrets and Postcommunions

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Collects: The Compressed Petition

On completing this unit, you can:

- identify the address, amplification, petition, desired result, and conclusion of a collect;
- untangle nested relatives, ablative absolutes, and paired gerunds;
- preserve the rhetorical focus after making a prose-order reconstruction.

A Roman collect is a compact period, not a string of devotional slogans. Its usual architecture is (1) divine address, (2) a relative or participial reason for confidence, (3) one governing petition, (4) an *ut* or *ne* clause stating the desired effect, and (5) a mediation conclusion. Not every collect contains every member, and punctuation is a reading aid rather than a substitute for syntax.

A **Collect** is the presiding oration that gathers the assembly's petition into a compact prayer. A **period** is a sentence designed as an articulated whole whose subordinate members lead toward or depend on a governing member; it does not merely mean a long sentence. The **address** names the person addressed; an **amplification** expands that address, commonly by recalling a divine attribute or act; the **petition** states what is requested; the **desired result** states the end for which it is requested; and the **conclusion** supplies the conventional mediation. These are functional members, not guaranteed punctuation units.

1.1 Imperatives, infinitives, and ablative absolutes

Excita, quæsumus, Domine, potentiam tuam, et veni: ut ab imminetibus peccatorum nostrorum periculis, te mereamur protegente eripi, te liberante salvari.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica I Adventus, Collecta.

First isolate *excita* and *veni*, two coordinated imperatives. *quæsumus* is parenthetical and *Domine* vocative. Inside the *ut*-clause, *mereamur* governs the passive infinitives *eripi* and *salvari*. The separation phrase *ab imminetibus ... periculis* belongs especially with *eripi*. Both *te protegente* and *te liberante* are ablative absolutes; the pronoun is their subject, not the object of the infinitives.

Analytical order:

Domine, excita potentiam tuam et veni, ut mereamur eripi ab periculis peccatorum nostrorum te protegente et salvari te liberante.

Return then to the printed order: danger is placed before protection, and the balanced ablative absolutes make divine action surround the two infinitives.

1.2 Correlative relatives

A **correlative** pair uses matched words to link corresponding roles. In the genitive pair *cuius ... eius*, the first member introduces the relative relation (“whose”) and the second resumes it (“of that same one”); agreement and case still have to be parsed separately.

Deus, qui hanc sacratissimam noctem veri luminis fecisti illustratione clarescere: da, quæsumus; ut, cuius lucis mysteria in terra cognovimus, eius quoque gaudiis in cælo perfruamur.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), In Nativitate Domini, ad primam Missam in nocte, Collecta.

The relative *qui* addresses the same *Deus*; its second-person verb *fecisti* is normal because the antecedent is vocative in function. *facere* with infinitive appears as *fecisti ... clarescere*; *illustratione* is ablative of means, and *veri luminis* defines the illumination. The petition is the bare imperative *da*; its content is the following *ut*-clause. *cuius ... eius* is a correlative: the light whose mysteries were known is the light whose joys are enjoyed. *perfruamur* is deponent and governs ablative *gaudiis*.

1.3 Gerunds as divine accompaniment

The ablative gerunds *præveniando* and *adiuvando* name ways of acting; they do not agree with *vota*.

Deus, qui hodierna die per Unigenitum tuum æternitatis nobis aditum, devicta morte, reserasti: vota nostra, quæ præveniando aspiras, etiam adiuvando proseguere.

Source: *Missale Romanum* (1962), Dominica Resurrectionis, Collecta.

The main petition is *prosequere*, a deponent imperative, with *vota nostra* as object. The relative *quæ* also has *vota* as antecedent and object of *aspiras*. The ablative gerunds *præveniando* and *adiuvando* express the manner or accompanying divine action: grace inspires desires beforehand and carries them through by helping. In the relative amplification, *aditum* is the object of *reserasti*, *nobis* dative of advantage, and *devicta morte* an ablative absolute.

1.4 A collect lexicon

Learn families in their recurrent constructions:

- *præsta, concede, tribue, largire, da* introduce petitions;
- *mereor + infinitive* means “be found or deemed worthy to”; *dignor + infinitive*, “deign or be pleased to”; and *valeam + infinitive*, “be able to.” Determine the wider theology from the prayer and its sources rather than from these constructions alone;
- *propitius* is often predicative/adverbial with an imperative;
- *familia, populus, Ecclesia, vota, desideria* commonly become subjects or objects far from their modifiers;
- *prævenio, prosequor, perficio, perago* describe grace beginning, accompanying, and completing an action.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Imperatives, infinitives, and ablative absolutes — transfer practice

Connection. Compression is manageable when each non-finite form is attached before the sentence is rendered.

Transfer task. On the guided Collect, make a finite-spine line and hang every infinitive and ablative absolute beneath its governor with relative time and voice.

Retrieval check. Name the subject of each non-finite construction, stated or supplied.

1.2 Correlative relatives — transfer practice

Connection. A repeated demonstrative or relative can bind distant parts of the prayer without creating a new independent clause.

Transfer task. Trace the lesson's correlative pair with arrows, then replace the nouns in a project-composed parallel while preserving gender, number, and internal case.

Retrieval check. State which features come from the antecedent and which from the relative's own clause.

1.3 Gerunds as divine accompaniment — transfer practice

Connection. A gerund is a verbal noun whose case and governor must be explained before an English participle is chosen.

Transfer task. For each gerund in the lesson, record case, governor, verbal complement, and the relation it adds to the petition.

Retrieval check. Distinguish a gerund from a gerundive in one deciding sentence.

1.4 A collect lexicon — transfer practice

Connection. A useful lexicon predicts constructions as well as meanings.

Transfer task. Choose four recurrent Collect verbs from the lesson and give principal parts, expected complement, one printed form, and one plausible wrong parse.

Retrieval check. Retrieve the complement pattern without supplying an English translation first.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit III.3: Collects

Worksheet III.9 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.9

Focus: Advent collect architecture

Use: Use the five-part collect frame.

1. **Text:** *Excita, quæsumus, Domine, potentiam tuam, et veni: ut ab imminentibus peccatorum nostrorum periculis, te mereamur protegente eripi, te liberante salvari.*

Passage ID: III.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Label address, petitions, desired result, infinitives, and absolutes.

-
2. Why is *te* ablative rather than accusative in both participial phrases?

-
3. Write the two balanced result members in minimal analytical order.

-
4. Change the prayer's beneficiary to singular "I" only inside the result clause.

-
5. Build a family ledger for *liberante* with four related forms and their parts of speech.

-
6. Answer in Latin: *A quibus periculis eripi petimus?*
-

Worksheet III.12 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** III.12**Focus:** Unseen collect audit**Use:** No facing text; one dictionary lookup after mapping.

1. **Text:** *Omnipotens et misericors Deus, de cuius munere venit, ut tibi a fidelibus tuis digne et laudabiliter serviatur: tribue, quæsumus, nobis; ut ad promissiones tuas sine offensione curramus.*

Passage ID: III.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Label architecture and every subordinate clause.

-
2. Write a prose-order line for the first period.

-
3. What is the grammatical subject/content of *venit*?

-
4. Parse *serviatur* and explain the two dependents around it.

-
5. Answer in Latin: *Quo currere petimus?*

-
6. Score the passage: list one word worth a lookup and one word that should be solved morphologically.
-

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: On an unseen Collect, recover the complete grammatical spine, label architecture only as strongly as the wording permits, and give a direct sense with no facing translation and no more than one justified lookup.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-III.4, Secrets and Postcommunions.

If it is not met: Worksheets III.10 and III.11 remain optional correlative-relative and gerund remediation.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Imperatives, infinitives, and ablative absolutes — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model identifies the main petition first, treats complementary infinitives as dependent, and gives each absolute its own ablative subject. A translation without those attachments is incomplete.

Correlative relatives — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The acceptable model preserves the pair's referent and grammatical roles; gender and number follow the antecedent, while case follows the relative's function.

Gerunds as divine accompaniment — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing record gives the governing preposition or case use and any object. A gerund is substantival; a gerundive is adjectival and agrees with a noun.

A collect lexicon — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each entry must identify a real construction—for example infinitive, content clause, dative, or object—and reject the wrong parse from morphology or government.

CHAPTER 2

Unit III.3: Collects

Solution III.9 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: III.9

Focus: Advent collect architecture

Use: Use the five-part collect frame.

1. **Text:** *Excita, quæsumus, Domine, potentiam tuam, et veni: ut ab imminentibus peccatorum nostrorum periculis, te mereamur protegente eripi, te liberante salvari.*

Passage ID: III.9.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Label address, petitions, desired result, infinitives, and absolutes.

Answer / notes: Address *Domine*; parenthesis *quæsumus*; petitions *excita ... et veni*; desired result *ut mereamur*; passive infinitives *eripi, salvari*; ablative absolutes *te protegente, te liberante*; danger phrase with *eripi*.

2. Why is *te* ablative rather than accusative in both participial phrases?

Answer / model: Present participles *protegente/liberante* are ablative singular and agree with ablative pronoun *te*, forming ablative absolutes. The passive infinitives do not take direct objects.

3. Write the two balanced result members in minimal analytical order.

Answer / model: *ut mereamur eripi te protegente et salvari te liberante.*

4. Change the prayer's beneficiary to singular "I" only inside the result clause.

Answer / model: *ut merear te protegente eripi, te liberante salvari.*

5. Build a family ledger for *liberante* with four related forms and their parts of speech.

Answer / model: Model: *liber, -era, -erum* free; *libero, -are* free; *liberator, -oris* deliverer; *liberatio, -onis* deliverance.

6. Answer in Latin: *A quibus periculis eripi petimus?*

Answer / model: *Ab imminentibus peccatorum nostrorum periculis eripi petimus.*

Solution III.12 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: III.12

Focus: Unseen collect audit

Use: No facing text; one dictionary lookup after mapping.

1. **Text:** *Omnipotens et misericors Deus, de cuius munere venit, ut tibi a fidelibus tuis digne et laudabiliter serviatur: tribue, quæsumus, nobis; ut ad promissiones tuas sine offensione curramus.*

Passage ID: III.12.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Label architecture and every subordinate clause.

Answer / notes: Address *Omnipotens et misericors Deus*; relative reason *de cuius munere venit*; substantive *ut ... serviatur* is what comes from the gift; main petition *tribue nobis*; content/desired result *ut ... curramus*. In the first *ut*, *tibi* is dative and *a fidelibus tuis* agent; in the second, *ad promissiones* is goal and *sine offensione* manner. Source: Dominica XII post Pentecosten, Collecta.

2. Write a prose-order line for the first period.

Answer / model: *Deus omnipotens et misericors, de cuius munere venit ut a fidelibus tuis tibi digne et laudabiliter serviatur.*

3. What is the grammatical subject/content of *venit*?

Answer / model: The following substantive *ut*-clause, “that you be served.”

4. Parse *serviatur* and explain the two dependents around it.

Answer / model: Third singular present passive subjunctive of *servio*; dative *tibi* because *servio* governs dative, and personal agent *a fidelibus tuis*.

5. Answer in Latin: *Quo currere petimus?*

Answer / model: *Ad promissiones Dei sine offensione currere petimus.*

6. Score the passage: list one word worth a lookup and one word that should be solved morphologically.

Answer / model: A useful lookup may be *offensio* to distinguish stumbling/obstacle from personal offense. *serviatur* should be solved from *servio* and its passive-subjunctive ending before any lookup.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-III.3, *Collects: The Compressed Petition*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The selected worksheets teach one guided architecture and one transfer audit; the omitted variants remain targeted practice, not missing required content.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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